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TOGETHER, WE RISE

Focal Student Outcomes & Educational Equity

Office of Accountability, Equity, and Continuous Improvement

November 4, 2026

Agenda

01 Our Commitment Who Are Our Focal Students?

02 The Data Story Student Achievement Trends and Opportunities

03 Our Focal Students Success, Challenges, & District Response

04 From Evidence to Action Equity and Accountability

05 Q&A Open Discussion & Feedback

CENTRAL QUESTION

"What have we learned about our focal students, their educational experiences, and the conditions necessary for their success, and what must we do differently as a district?"

Learning Target & Success Criteria

LEARNING TARGET

By the end of this presentation, we will:

1. **Deepen** understanding of our focal student populations, including the historical and systemic conditions that have shaped their educational experiences.

2. **Examine** current student achievement outcomes to identify patterns of progress and areas requiring improvement.

3. **Understand** our collective responsibility to create the conditions, instructional experiences, and systems of support necessary for every student to thrive.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

We can demonstrate success when we:

1. **Articulate** why understanding the histories, strengths, and educational experiences of our focal students is essential to advancing educational equity.

2. **Identify** key patterns in student achievement, including where progress is occurring and where outcomes indicate a need for greater attention.

3. **Connect** the evidence presented to questions about district practices, resource allocation, instructional supports, and accountability for improving student outcomes.

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The Promise of Education Was Not Shared Equally.



Young students in a classroom at the Tuskegee Normal and Industrial Institute. Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division.

HISTORICAL TIMELINE

1900

A nation confronting the meaning of educational opportunity.

Educational access and quality were deeply divided across demographic lines, establishing systemic gaps that communities and institutions have spent over a century working to overcome.

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Who Are Our Focal Students, and Why Are They Historically Underserved?

Oregon's educational equity framework calls attention to students who have historically experienced inequitable access, opportunities, and outcomes.

Black Students

Educational access, representation, and opportunity

Native American Students

Sovereignty, culture, language, and educational opportunity

Multilingual Learners

Language as an asset and equitable access to rigorous instruction

Students with Disabilities

Rightful inclusion, accessibility, and high expectations

"Historically underserved" describes how educational systems have served students, not what students are capable of achieving.

WHY THE FOCUS?

ODE's accountability and equity frameworks make disparities visible and guide educational systems toward more equitable opportunities and outcomes.

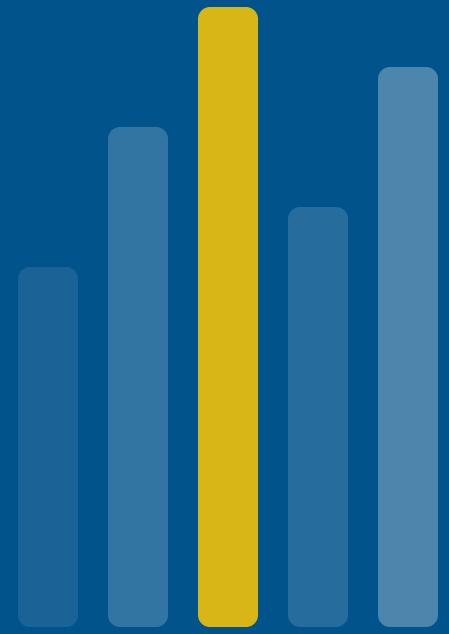
Source: ODE, Aligning for Student Success: Integrated Guidance 2025–27; PPS Racial Educational Equity Policy 2.10.010-P.

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The Data Story

OSAS: A measure of achievement against Oregon's academic standards.



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Black Student Achievement in PPS

"Black excellence is not an aspiration we must create. It is a reality our educational system must recognize, nurture, and never underestimate."

Black Student Achievement in PPS

2025–26 Oregon Statewide Assessment System (OSAS)

Grades 3–8: Meeting proficiency standards

Student group	English language arts	Math
Black students in PPS	19.7%	13.2%
Black students statewide	26.3%	17.8%
All PPS students	58.6%	52.1%

PPS compared with Black peers statewide

English: 6.6 percentage points lower

Math: 4.6 percentage points lower

Three-year Board benchmarks

Benchmark	2023–24	2024–25	2025–26
Grade 3 English	18.3%	19.8%	19.1%
Grade 5 Math	11.9%	10.9%	7.5%
Grade 8: Both subjects	3.7%	8.4%	5.8%

PPS trails Black peers statewide in both subjects. Black students did not meet the Board's annual improvement targets in any of these three benchmarks.

Proficiency rates measure meeting standards, not individual student growth.

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Native American Student Achievement in PPS

"Native students should never have to choose between academic success and the preservation of their identity, language, and culture."

Native American Student Achievement in PPS

2025–26 Oregon Statewide Assessment System (OSAS)

Grades 3–8: Meeting proficiency standards

Student group	English language arts	Math
Native American students in PPS	22.0%	20.6%
Native American students statewide	26.3%	17.6%
All PPS students	58.6%	52.1%

PPS compared with Native American peers statewide

English: 4.3 percentage points lower

Math: 3.0 percentage points higher

Three-year Board benchmarks

Benchmark	2023–24	2024–25	2025–26
Grade 3 English	16.7%	36.8%	19.0%
Grade 5 Math	5.6%	7.7%	23.1%
Grade 8: Both subjects	Suppressed*	21.4%	8.3%

*Fewer than 11 students.

Conclusion
PPS trails state peers in English and exceeds them in math. Progress varies by grade.

Note: Proficiency rates measure meeting standards, not individual student growth.
Method note: State grades 3–8 rates calculated from proficiency and performance-level counts; rounded to one decimal. State category: American Indian/Alaskan Native.
Sources: Fall 2026 PPS OSAS Board Memo; ODE 2025–26 Assessment Group Reports.

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English Language Learners Student Achievement in PPS

“For Multilingual Learners, Learning English should never mean waiting to learn rigorous academic content, and shedding their language and culture at the schoolhouse door.”

Multilingual Learner Achievement in PPS

2025–26 Oregon Statewide Assessment System (OSAS)

Meeting proficiency standards

Student group and grade span	English Language Arts	Math
PPS Multilingual Learners • Grades 3–8	6.2%	8.5%
State Multilingual Learners • All tested grades, including Grade 11	6.1%	6.1%
All PPS students • Grades 3–8	58.6%	52.1%

Connecting Language Development to Academic Achievement

Strengthening grade-level instruction, language development, and targeted supports to accelerate student learning.

Data Note: PPS results reflect Grades 3–8; statewide English learner results include Grades 3–8 and 11. Comparisons should be interpreted with caution.

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Special Education Student Achievement in PPS

“Access to the classroom is not the same as access to learning. True inclusion requires opportunity, rigorous instruction, and meaningful participation.”

Special Education Student Achievement in PPS

2025–26 Oregon Statewide Assessment System (OSAS)

Grades 3–8: Meeting proficiency standards

Student group	English language arts	Math
PPS students receiving special education services	34.0%	31.6%
Students with disabilities statewide	18.8%	15.9%
All PPS students	58.6%	52.1%

PPS compared with statewide peers

English:	Math:
15.2 percentage points higher	15.7 percentage points higher

What the results show

- PPS proficiency is substantially higher than statewide peers receiving special education services.
- The memo reports multi-year gains for this group.
- About one in three PPS students receiving special education services met standards in each subject.

Progress and a strong state comparison. Continued work to close gaps within PPS.

Note: Proficiency rates measure meeting standards, not individual student growth.
Method: State grades 3–8 rates calculated from proficiency and performance-level counts; rounded to one decimal. State participation is below 90% for this group; interpret with caution.
Sources: Fall 2026 PPS OSAS Board Memo; ODE 2025–26 Assessment Group Reports.

OUR FOCAL STUDENTS

Successes, Challenges & District Response

PRESENTERS



Willie Williams III

Director, Grice-Adair Center for Educational Excellence



Marquita Guzman

Director, Indian Education Program



Will Flores

Director, Multilingual Services



Sabrina Wood

Interim Senior Director, Special Education Services

Black Students in PPS

History & Educational Access

Systemic Context & Advocacy

Racial exclusion, segregation, and displacement have shaped educational opportunity in Portland.

Black families and educators have sustained the push for equitable access and investment.

Strengths & Assets

Student & Community Power

Black students bring diverse experiences, cultural knowledge, creativity, and leadership.

BSU councils provide opportunities to shape district decisions, supported by family advocacy and community expertise.

Successes & Bright Spots

Progress & Foundations

Slight assessment gains across grades 3–8 overall, though progress remains insufficient.

Black Excellence Preschool, culturally specific partnerships, and student leadership opportunities provide foundations to strengthen.

Priorities for Improvement

1. Strengthen Academic Achievement in Literacy and Mathematics

Ensure Black students experience rigorous grade-level instruction, effective instructional practices, and timely, targeted academic interventions.

2. Accelerate Progress at Critical Academic Milestones

Prioritize third-grade literacy, fifth-grade mathematics, and eighth-grade readiness for high school through focused instructional supports and ongoing progress monitoring.

Sense of Belonging • Culturally Affirming Learning • Centering Black Student Voice and Leadership

Supporting Black Students: Our Response & Next Steps

Recruit and retain Black educators and administrators

Research found that Black students with a Black teacher **gained** approximately 3–4 percentile points in reading and math.

Implement Ideal Student Learning Action 2

Ensure Black students consistently engage in challenging, grade level reading and mathematics tasks using High-Quality Instructional Materials.

What's Needed to Accelerate Growth

Expand access to enrichment

Unite Grice-Adair Center for Educational Excellence, schools, families, and partners toward 8,000 enrichment hours by eighth grade, removing access barriers and tracking student progress.

Provide timely support that meets students' learning needs

Use student work and assessment data to identify gaps, deliver focused reading and math support, and adjust instruction as students progress.

Monitor progress and adjust supports

Teaching and Learning, Data and Accountability should review academic growth, participation, attendance, and belonging quarterly against Board targets, adjusting instruction and resources as needed.

IN ORDER TO ACCELERATE GROWTH FOR BLACK STUDENTS

PPS must strengthen instruction, recruit and retain Black educators, expand enrichment access, and use evidence to improve supports.

Native Students in PPS

History & Educational Access

- Native communities had educational systems long before public schools
- Federal education policy was intentionally used as a tool of assimilation
- Native students also experienced exclusion and erasure within public education

Strengths & Assets

- Resistance and Resilience
- Indian Education Embedded in the School Experience
- Family and Community Voice is central
- Collaboration and Co-development of Native student supports with FACE

Successes & Bright Spots

5.2% Table

Attendance for Native Students is rising each year.

- 2024-25- 33%
- 2025-26- 41%
- Currently up 5.2%

50.0%

Native student engagement is up by 50% at Indian Education events & programming

Priorities for Improvement

- Improving Native student outcomes
- Expand opportunities for Native student engagement, belonging, and cultural learning
- Strengthen college and career readiness and well-being through culturally grounded, career-connected learning.

Sense of Belonging • Culturally-Connected Learning • Centering Native Student Voice & Leadership

Supporting Native Students: Our Response & Next Steps

American Indian/Alaska Native Student Success Plan (AIANSSP) Grant Awardee

Focus on centering culturally responsive approaches that center Native student voices

Grow Native supports and programming

In alignment with decades of community feedback work towards a K5 focus option school, co-located with Indian Education and establish a Native Center for Success

What's Needed to Accelerate Growth

Expanding PBL & Indigenous Ways of Knowing and Learning

Implement TH/SH with Fidelity

Support and Retain Native Educators

IN ORDER TO ACCELERATE GROWTH FOR NATIVE STUDENTS

"we must expand place-based learning and Indigenous ways of knowing, implement TH/SH with fidelity, and support and retain Native educators. Together, these practices create more culturally sustaining learning environments where Native students can see their histories, cultures, and ways of knowing reflected throughout their education.

Multilingual Learners in PPS

History & Educational Access

Pull-out ELD models and English-only practices have historically limited multilingual learners' access to rigorous, grade-level instruction and contributed to prolonged ELD status.

Strengths & Assets

Multilingual learners bring rich cultural knowledge, diverse perspectives, and linguistic strengths that enrich classrooms and our school communities.

Successes & Bright Spots

85.7%

4-year graduation rate for **former** English learners.

17% ⬆ graph

Increase at Lent of MLs scoring proficient/early proficient.

290

K-12 teachers trained in SIOP

Priorities for Improvement

- Accelerate literacy and mathematics achievement through rigorous, language-rich instruction.
- Strengthen English language development and graduation outcomes.
- Increase by at least 20% the numbers of MLs who exit ELD within 5 years.

Equitable Access • Linguistic Identity • Rigorous Instruction • Relevant Support

Supporting Multilingual Learners: Our Response & Next Steps

Integrated English Language Development (ELD)

Co-teaching and collaborative planning integrate language development with grade-level content, increasing access to rigorous instruction and meaningful participation alongside peers.

Dual Language Immersion (DLI)

Develops bilingualism, biliteracy, and academic achievement while affirming students' linguistic and cultural identities and fostering belonging.

What's Needed to Accelerate Growth

Equitable Resources

Consistently well-resourced multilingual programs across all PPS schools.

Diverse Workforce Stability

Prioritize recruitment and retention of multilingual and multicultural educators.

Effective Staffing

Establish staffing models that provide adequate time and capacity for co-planning, co-teaching, and targeted language instruction.

IN ORDER TO ACCELERATE GROWTH FOR MULTILINGUAL LEARNERS

"Accelerating outcomes for multilingual learners requires more than strong instructional models. It requires sustained investment in the educators, staffing structures, and resources necessary to implement these models effectively and equitably across our district."

Students with Disabilities in PPS

History & Educational Access

- Special Education has a long, entrenched history of exclusion.
- Special Education also has a long history of advocacy.

Strengths & Assets

- A strong workforce of educators
- A thoughtful team of parents and caregivers
- Students who are brilliant contributors to our communities of learners

Successes & Bright Spots

- Inclusive Schools Progress Report
- Strong Interdepartmental partnerships
- Implementation of consistent process and procedures

Priorities for Improvement

- Access to core curriculum and core assessments
- Strengthening programming for Autistic students
- Consistent and quality training of educators
- Decreased Exclusionary Discipline

Equitable Access • Student Independence • Rigorous Instruction • Relevant Support

Supporting Students with Disabilities: Our Response & Next Steps

Receiving the full Continuum of Services

Students with disabilities are afforded access to the full continuum of services based on the legal requirement of Least Restrictive Environment

Postsecondary and Transition Planning

An essential element of Special Education Programming is planning for Post Secondary through transition planning and goals

What's Needed to Accelerate Growth

Legally Compliant IEPs

Legally compliant IEP process and documents is the direction for teams to serve students

Strong Program Guidance

Creating consistent programming for students with disabilities is essential to ensure student growth and access

Strong Tier I Instruction

Continued commitment and attention to serving our students as General Education students first

IN ORDER TO ACCELERATE GROWTH FOR STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

"Accelerating growth for kids in Special Education is achieved not by pulling them out for separate instruction or lowering expectations, but by shifting our pedagogical aim toward universal design and full belonging"

Dr. Shelley Moore

FOCAL STUDENT OUTCOMES & EDUCATIONAL EQUITY

From Understanding to Responsibility

What must we do differently as a district to change student outcomes and expand what's possible for their futures?

We've Made the Investments. Are ALL Students Experiencing the Benefits?

What We've Invested In

Core ELA and Math Instructional Materials

High-quality, grade-level instructional materials across content areas

Professional Learning and Leadership Development

Targeted professional development for campus administrators and strong instructional leadership supports.

Formative Assessment & Improvement Systems

Formative assessment tools, classroom checks for understanding, and school improvement frameworks

Professional Learning Communities

Collaborative teacher teams focused on analyzing student data, aligning instruction, and continuous improvement.

What We Still Need?

100% Fidelity to Implementation

Are ALL focal students experiencing high-quality, grade-level instruction across all of our schools?

Strategic Staffing and Instructional Supports

Strategically align staffing and resources to strengthen instruction and accelerate learning in schools serving higher concentrations of focal students.

Consistent Classroom Practice & Student Impact

Ensuring instructional investments translate into daily evidence-based practices that directly accelerate student achievement.

Developing Collective Efficacy

Ensuring educators share the conviction that their actions can positively influence student outcomes, especially for focal student populations.

What Must We Do Differently to Accelerate Learning?

FROM INVESTMENT TO INSTRUCTIONAL IMPACT

Building on PPS investments through effective implementation of HQIM, evidence-based instruction, and targeted supports responsive to our focal students.

1. Deliver Explicit, Evidence-Based Instruction Aligned to HQIM

Strengthen instructional delivery through clear modeling, guided practice, checks for understanding, and actionable feedback, using our adopted materials to ensure rigorous, grade-level learning.

2. Accelerate Learning Through Targeted, Intensive Supports

Provide timely, evidence-based interventions, high-dosage tutoring, and additional learning time aligned with core instruction and identified student needs, without lowering expectations or limiting access to grade-level content.

3. Respond to the Distinct Needs of Our Focal Students

Use HQIM alongside appropriate linguistic supports, culturally affirming practices, accessibility, and specially designed instruction to respond to individual learning needs while maintaining high expectations.

4. Use Formative Assessment to Drive Instruction and Accountability

Leverage curriculum-embedded assessments, student work, and ongoing checks for understanding to adjust instruction, monitor progress, evaluate interventions, and direct resources where needed.

CLOSING STATEMENT

“Our measure of success is not what we've adopted or implemented. It is what students are learning and what that learning makes possible for their futures.

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FOCAL STUDENT OUTCOMES & EDUCATIONAL EQUITY

The Future We Want for Our Students

Every student leaves Portland Public Schools with the knowledge, skills, confidence, and opportunities to shape their own future.

01

College & Career Readiness

Prepared for postsecondary education, meaningful careers, and lifelong learning.

02

Economic Mobility

The opportunity to earn a living wage, achieve financial stability, and build generational wealth.

03

Identity & Belonging

The confidence to navigate the world with their identities, cultures, and strengths affirmed.

04

Choice & Opportunity

The freedom to pursue their aspirations, support their families, and contribute to their communities.

> ***"We are not simply working to improve test scores. We are working to expand what is possible in the lives of children."***